

15 (a) Show that the equation $x^3 + 7x - 5 = 0$ has a solution between $x = 0$ and $x = 1$ (2)

(b) Show that the equation $x^3 + 7x - 5 = 0$ can be arranged to give $x = \frac{5}{x^2 + 7}$ (2)

(c) Starting with $x_0 = 1$, use the iteration formula $x_{n+1} = \frac{5}{x_n^2 + 7}$ three times to find an estimate for the solution of $x^3 + 7x - 5 = 0$ (3)

(d) By substituting your answer to part (c) into $x^3 + 7x - 5$, comment on the accuracy of your estimate for the solution to $x^3 + 7x - 5 = 0$ (2)

(Total for Question 15 is 9 marks)